

Ceres

Cultivate your academic life.

Version: Vision 1.0

Vision

Ceres is an academic workspace designed to help university students organise, manage and collaborate throughout their degree.

Rather than attempting to replace a single application, Ceres provides one cohesive environment where students can manage lectures, assignments, notes, revision, group projects and day-to-day academic life.

The goal is not simply to increase productivity, but to reduce the mental overhead of university by giving every piece of academic work a logical place to live.

Ceres should become the workspace students naturally open whenever they attend lectures, revise, complete coursework or collaborate with others.

Name

Ceres is named after both:

- The Roman goddess of agriculture, growth and cultivation.
- The largest dwarf planet in the asteroid belt.

The name reflects the philosophy of the application.

Students are not simply completing assignments—they are cultivating knowledge, skills and long-term growth.

Vision Statement

Create the most intuitive academic workspace for students by bringing organisation, learning and collaboration into a single, thoughtfully designed experience.

Core Principles

Cultivate, don't overwhelm

The application should encourage progress rather than punish procrastination.

Everything belongs somewhere

Students should never wonder where information should be stored.

Every lecture, assignment, note and file should have a natural home.

Connected information

Nothing exists in isolation.

Lectures connect to notes.

Notes connect to revision.

Revision connects to assignments.

Assignments connect to modules.

Everything should naturally flow together.

Calm by default

The interface should reduce stress.

Visual clutter should be avoided.

Information should be prioritised.

Animations should feel subtle rather than distracting.

Collaboration first

University is increasingly collaborative.

Where appropriate, every academic object should support collaboration.

Progressive complexity

Essential features should be immediately accessible.

Advanced features should reveal themselves naturally over time.

Target Users

Primary

- Undergraduate students

Secondary

- Postgraduate students

Future

- Colleges
 - Sixth Forms
 - Apprenticeships
 - Independent learners
-

Problems Ceres Solves

Students currently juggle many disconnected applications.

Typical workflow

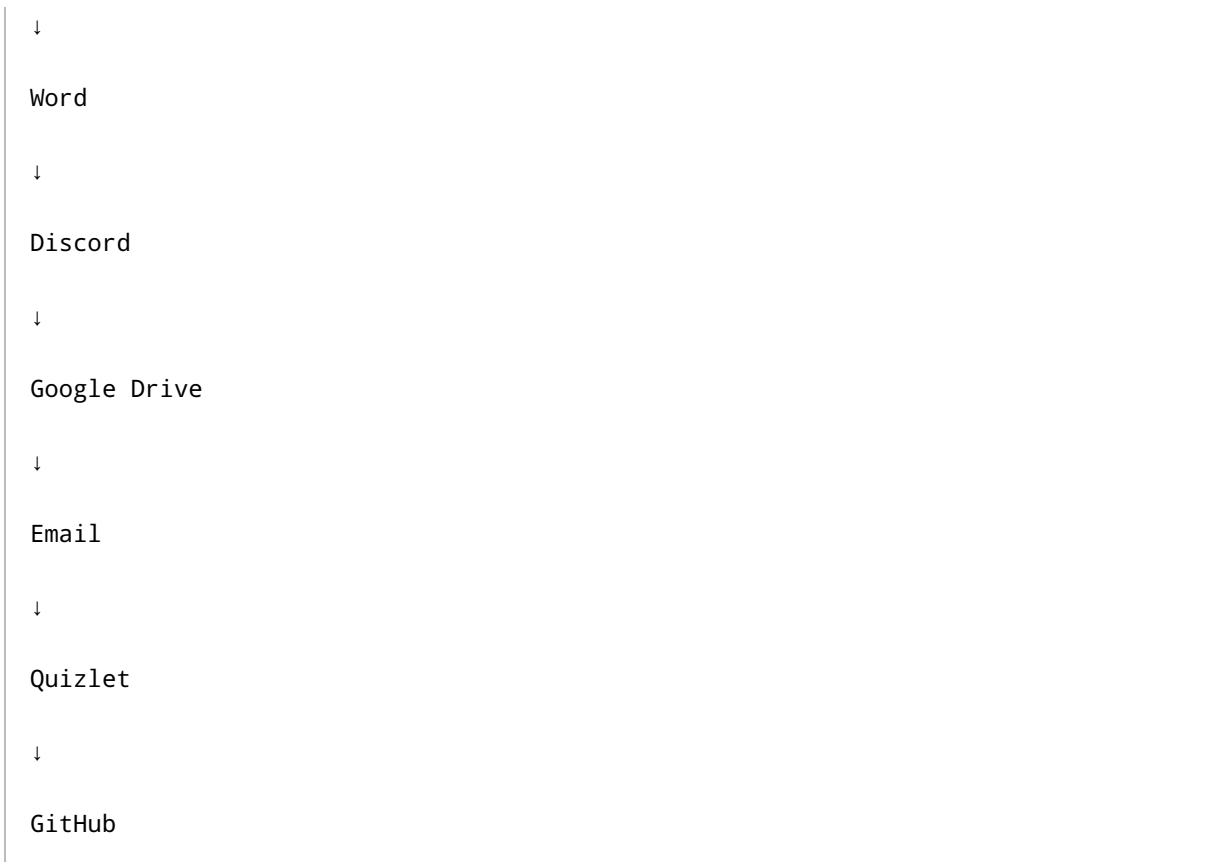
University Portal

↓

Google Calendar

↓

Notion



Every context switch creates friction.

Ceres aims to reduce these interruptions by creating a single academic workspace.

Product Pillars

Organisation

Timetables

Assignments

Tasks

Files

Calendar

Goals

Learning

Lecture notes

Revision

Flashcards

Study sessions

Confidence tracking

Collaboration

Group projects

Messaging

Shared notes

Study groups

Shared whiteboards

Personal Growth

Habits

Progress

Achievements

Statistics

Placement tracking

User Journey

First Launch

Create account



Choose university (optional)



Choose course



Import timetable (optional)



Complete onboarding



Dashboard

Daily Flow

Open Ceres



View Dashboard



Attend Lecture



Take Notes



Review Assignment Progress



Complete Study Session



Update Progress



End of Day Summary

Core Modules

Dashboard

A personalised overview of today's academic life.

Requirements

- Daily schedule
 - Upcoming deadlines
 - Assignment progress
 - Study reminders
 - Recent notes
 - Quick actions
 - Calendar overview
 - Goals
 - Activity summary
-

Calendar

Requirements

- Day
- Week
- Month
- Recurring events

- Colour categories
 - Academic events
 - Personal events
 - Shared calendars
 - Deadline integration
-

Timetable

Requirements

- Weekly timetable
 - Module grouping
 - Lecture information
 - Room information
 - Attendance tracking
 - Navigation to lecture pages
-

Modules

Each module should become its own workspace.

Requirements

- Lectures
 - Assignments
 - Notes
 - Resources
 - Revision
 - Discussions
-

Lecture Hub

Requirements

- Notes
 - Attachments
 - Images
 - Recordings
 - Related assignments
 - Revision links
 - Discussion
-

Assignments

Requirements

Each assignment should support

- Title
- Module
- Deadline
- Progress
- Priority
- Status
- Notes
- Checklist
- Attachments
- Group members
- Estimated workload

Views

- Upcoming
 - Active
 - Completed
 - Overdue
-

Notes

Requirements

Support

- Rich text
 - Markdown
 - Images
 - Tables
 - Checklists
 - Mathematical notation
 - Code blocks
 - Search
 - Organisation
-

Revision

Requirements

Track

- Topics
 - Confidence
 - Flashcards
 - Study sessions
 - Weak areas
 - Progress
 - Practice questions
 - Mock exams
-

Whiteboard

Requirements

- Infinite canvas
 - Drawing
 - Sticky notes
 - Shapes
 - Images
 - Collaboration
 - Export
-

Study Sessions

Requirements

Students should be able to

- Create sessions
 - Invite friends
 - Track study time
 - Share notes
 - Collaborate
-

Friends

Requirements

- Profiles
- Friend requests
- Shared workspaces

- Shared calendars
 - Shared revision
 - Study groups
-

Messaging

Requirements

- Direct messages
 - Group conversations
 - Reactions
 - Replies
 - File sharing
 - Search
-

Group Projects

Requirements

- Dedicated workspace
 - Shared files
 - Shared notes
 - Task boards
 - Meeting notes
 - Timeline
 - Progress tracking
-

Tasks

Requirements

- Quick creation
 - Priorities
 - Categories
 - Deadlines
 - Recurring tasks
 - Progress tracking
-

Files

Requirements

- Organised storage
 - Tags
 - Search
 - Preview
 - Sharing
 - Recent files
-

Goals

Requirements

- Daily
 - Weekly
 - Semester
 - Progress tracking
 - Completion history
-

Habits

Examples

- Study
- Sleep
- Exercise
- Reading
- Hydration

Requirements

- Daily tracking
 - Streaks
 - Statistics
 - History
-

Placement Tracker

Requirements

- Applications
 - Companies
 - Interviews
 - Notes
 - Deadlines
 - Status
 - CV tracking
-

User Profiles

Requirements

- Profile
 - Statistics
 - Achievements
 - Modules
 - Privacy settings
-

Notifications

Requirements

- Assignment reminders
 - Lecture reminders
 - Calendar reminders
 - Group updates
 - Friend requests
 - Configurable preferences
-

Search

Global search should locate

- Modules
- Lectures
- Notes
- Assignments
- Files

- Friends
 - Messages
 - Tasks
 - Events
-

Functional Requirements

User Management

The system shall allow users to

- Create an account
 - Sign in
 - Edit profile information
 - Manage privacy settings
 - Delete their account
-

Academic Management

The system shall allow users to

- Manage modules
 - Organise lectures
 - Create notes
 - Track assignments
 - Manage revision
 - Store resources
-

Productivity

The system shall allow users to

- Manage tasks
 - Manage calendars
 - Create reminders
 - Set goals
 - Track habits
-

Collaboration

The system shall allow users to

- Communicate
 - Collaborate on notes
 - Share workspaces
 - Create study groups
 - Manage group projects
-

Personalisation

Users shall be able to

- Customise dashboards
 - Change themes
 - Reorder widgets
 - Configure notifications
-

Non-Functional Requirements

Performance

The application should remain responsive during normal use.

Reliability

Student work should never be lost.

Accessibility

The application should be usable by students with a wide range of accessibility requirements.

Security

Personal and academic information should remain protected.

Scalability

The platform should support future growth without requiring architectural redesign.

Maintainability

Features should evolve independently without negatively impacting existing functionality.

Extensibility

Future modules should integrate naturally into the existing workspace.

User Stories

Dashboard

As a student

I want to immediately understand what requires my attention today
so I can begin work without searching through multiple applications.

Assignments

As a student

I want to monitor coursework progress
so deadlines never become overwhelming.

Notes

As a student

I want all lecture notes organised by module
so revision becomes effortless.

Revision

As a student

I want to identify my weakest topics

so I can spend my revision time effectively.

Collaboration

As a student

I want to work with classmates in shared spaces

so group projects remain organised.

Habits

As a student

I want to build consistent study habits

so I improve over the duration of my degree.

Information Architecture

Dashboard

|

|— Calendar

|— Timetable

|— Modules

|

|— Lectures

|— Assignments

|— Notes

|— Revision

|

|— Tasks

|— Files

|— Whiteboard

|— Study Sessions

|— Friends

- └─ Messages
- └─ Group Projects
- └─ Goals
- └─ Habits
- └─ Placement
- └─ Search
- └─ Settings

Long-Term Vision

Ceres should become more than an organisational tool.

It should become the digital academic workspace students rely on throughout their education—a place where they think, learn, collaborate and grow.

The product should be recognised not because it offers more features than competing applications, but because it provides a calmer, more coherent experience that genuinely helps students cultivate their academic journey.